Who Decides Idaho?

The one-party electorate, resolved by party — from 1.03 million individual registration and vote records

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AI-assisted drafting and analysis review. All figures are reproducible from public-record data available through lawful request and from the open-source scripts cited below, including `scripts/verify_who_decides_id.py`*. The paper source, code, and data-acquisition recipe are public at https://github.com/skirby359/who-decides; the underlying voter file is not redistributed. Contact: kirby@tikorconsulting.com.*

Deep-red companion to `who-decides-washington.md` *and* `who-decides-new-york.md`*. Washington showed the off-year electorate is older; New York (deep blue) showed* whose *electorate ages and who is locked out. Idaho completes the set from the other pole: a state where the November general is a formality and the closed Republican primary is the real election — so the question "who decides" has a sharper, more literal answer than in any two-party state. DRAFT — pending human/editorial sign-off.* `scripts/verify_who_decides_id.py` *scrapes this paper and asserts its figures against the voter file, with the exceptions the script names in its own output; see* `electoral-health-audit-log.md`*. That gate is automated and is not the sign-off. The sign-off is a person reading the paper end to end, recorded in* `id-submission-notes.md` *§Sign-off.***

This line previously read "AI-side reproduction verified (all `verify_*` *scripts re-run, exit 0)". That formulation is worth nothing and the New York companion says so in its own front matter: a script with no assertions and no failing exit path returns 0 whatever the data says, so "exit 0" is a claim about the script, not the paper. What replaces it names the assertion, which is the thing a reader can check.*

Provenance. All figures from `data/id_vrdb.duckdb` *— Idaho's statewide voter file with history (1,029,938 registrants; individual party affiliation + age + per-election vote history incl. the primary ballot each voter pulled, all ~100% populated) — via* `scripts/diag_id_turnout_party.py` *and* `scripts/diag_id_electorate_extras.py`*. The donor layer joins Idaho Sunshine state contributions via* `scripts/match_id_voters_to_donors.py`*. Competitiveness from* `forecast_predictions`*. Each figure below traces to one of these scripts.*

Load-bearing caveats. (1) The file is the current (2026) roll, which has shrunk to 1.03M from the ~1.18M registered at the 2024 election (Idaho purges aggressively and same-day registrants churn). Voters who cast a past ballot but were since purged/moved are absent, so any turnout rate computed from this file is biased high — materially: an all-voter 2024 rate comes out near 94% against the official 77.8%. The bias is larger *for high-churn groups (young, unaffiliated, movers), so even within-year cross-group rate comparisons are unreliable. This paper therefore reports composition shares only (who the electorate is), which need no registration denominator, and reports no turnout rates. See Methods. (2) Idaho publishes age, not date of birth; election-time age is approximated as* `age - (2026 - year)`*, accurate to ~1 year — fine for bands, and we never claim exact ages. (3) "UNAFF" = Idaho's unaffiliated registration; its partisan lean is never imputed.*

Abstract

In a one-party state, the general election is not where governing choices are made. Idaho is **63%** Republican and **12%** Democratic by registration, and its officeholders are chosen in a closed May Republican primary that most of the state cannot or does not enter. Using the statewide voter file for **1,029,938** registrants, with party of record and the party ballot each voter actually pulled, this paper measures who enters that decisive contest. Two findings are specific to Idaho rather than replications of the off-cycle turnout literature. First, the age gap is party-neutral: Republicans and Democrats among 2024 general voters are within a fraction of a point on the 65-and-over share, **31.7%** against **31.5%**, and four years apart on median age, so Idaho's youth sits in the unaffiliated bloc rather than in either party — inverting the national older-is-more-Republican pattern and reversing what the New York companion finds. Second, because the file records ballot choice, the exclusion of unaffiliated registrants from the decisive primary is measured rather than inferred. The May 2024 primary electorate runs **85.2%** Republican by registration against **62.9%** of the roll, a Republican-minus-Democratic margin of **76.8** points against **51.1** on the rolls, and its Republican-ballot voters have a median age of **63** with **46.7%** aged 65 or over. Yet the primary decides only where it is contested: of **99** Republican legislative primaries in 2024, **52** were contested and **47** offered a single candidate, so for roughly half of Republican-held seats the binding choice occurred at candidate filing. Every one of the **35** legislative districts leans Republican and none is competitive by registration. The paper reports composition shares and deliberately reports no turnout rates, because a current-extract roll that has contracted from about 1.18 to 1.03 million inflates every rate.

Keywords. one-party dominance; closed primaries; nominating electorate; voter file; party registration; unaffiliated voters;

uncontested elections; turnout composition; election timing; Idaho

The question

How *many* people vote is the wrong question for understanding how a state is governed. The right one is *who* — and in Idaho the answer is unusually stark, because Idaho is a one-party state by registration (**63% Republican, 12% Democratic, 24% unaffiliated**) whose officeholders are chosen not in November but in a **closed May Republican primary** that most of the state cannot or does not enter.

The short answer: **the people who actually decide Idaho are a gray, Republican, self-selected slice of an already-Republican state.** In November the electorate is broadly representative; in the primary that settles nearly every seat it is older and drawn almost entirely from one party — and the 24% of registrants who decline a party are, by the design of the closed primary, standing outside the room where it happens.

Two of these findings are specific to Idaho, not a replication of the off-cycle turnout literature. First, the age gap here is **party-neutral**: Idaho's Republicans and Democrats are nearly the same age, and the young sit in the *unaffiliated* bloc rather than in either party — inverting the national "older-is-more-Republican" pattern and reversing what the New York companion found. Second, because the file records the party ballot each voter actually pulled, the exclusion of the unaffiliated from the decisive primary is **measured, not inferred**.

I. The off-year electorate is older — Idaho replicates Washington

Share of the general-election electorate by age band:

Election	Type	18–29	30–44	45–64	65+	median
Nov 2024	Presidential	15.2%	23.4%	32.4%	29.0%	52
Nov 2022	Midterm	**8.6%**	20.7%	36.3%	**34.4%**	57
Nov 2020	Presidential	13.8%	23.9%	36.1%	26.3%	52
—	Registration baseline (2026)	15.2%	22.8%	30.9%	31.0%	52

As the contest shrinks (presidential → midterm), the under-30 share nearly halves (15.2% → 8.6%) and the 65+ share swells (29% → 34%); median age rises from 52 to 57. **Behavior, not rolls** — the roll's age structure barely moves between the two elections, so the shift is who *shows up*, not who is registered. A Das-Gupta decomposition points the same way (attributing the 65+ rise mostly to turnout rather than to roll composition), though in Idaho that rate-based cut carries the survivorship caveat above; it is reported here as directionally consistent with Washington and New York, where the roll is stable and the decomposition is reliable. The young *choose not to vote* in lower-salience cycles — the classic **surge-and-decline** pattern (Campbell 1960), measured here across the presidential-to-midterm drop. (That is distinct from, though it rhymes with, the *off-cycle / odd-year local-election* timing literature — Anzia 2014; Hajnal & Trounstine 2005 — which motivates the on-cycle remedy discussed below: Idaho's local offices, like Washington's, sit off the federal calendar entirely.) As in Washington and New York, this is an institutional, timing-fixable pattern, not a registration artifact.

II. In Idaho the age gap is *not* partisan — the youth is in the middle

This is where Idaho diverges sharply from New York. In New York the Republican electorate ages hardest; in Idaho the two major parties age almost identically. Share of each party's 2024 general-election voters by age, plus median age:

Party	share 65+	share 18–29	median age
Republican	31.7%	12.7%	54
Democratic	31.5%	19.4%	50
Unaffiliated	**21.3%**	**19.6%**	**46**

Party	share 65+	share 18–29	median age
Other (Lib/Con)	10.0%	23.0%	39

The Republican and Democratic electorates are within a fraction of a point on the 65+ share and only four years apart on median age. Idaho's **youth lives outside the two major parties** — in the unaffiliated bloc (median 46) and the minor parties (median 38). That matters because, as Sections III–IV show, those are precisely the blocs that vanish from the contest that decides. The generational sorting that makes "older = redder" a useful heuristic nationally simply does not hold here: in Idaho, older = *more attached to a party at all*, not more Republican.

III. The unaffiliated quarter: turns out in November, locked out in May

Idaho's 245,887 unaffiliated registrants (23.9% of the roll) are the recurring blind spot. Because Idaho's roll cannot support reliable turnout *rates* (Methods), we follow each bloc by its **share of the electorate** — a denominator-free measure — across the two contests:

Bloc	roll %	median age	% 65+	% 18–29	share of 2024 general electorate	share of 2024 primary electorate
Republican	62.9%	55	34.5%	12.6%	64.5%	**85.2%**
Unaffiliated	23.9%	46	22.4%	19.9%	22.6%	**5.9%**
Democratic	11.8%	50	32.4%	19.1%	11.6%	8.3%
Other	1.4%	40	11.0%	21.3%	1.3%	0.6%

The story is in the last two columns. The unaffiliated are **22.6% of the 2024 general electorate** — essentially their full 23.9% of the roll, so in November they show up. But they are only **5.9% of the May primary electorate**: a bloc that is nearly a quarter of the state, and a quarter of the November vote, casts about **one in seventeen** primary ballots. This is not apathy; it is architecture. Idaho's Republican primary is **closed**, so an unaffiliated voter must first affiliate to vote in the contest that actually chooses the winner. A quarter of the state opts to stay out — and in doing so sits out the decision.

> **A note on the roll itself.** Idaho's registration file shrank from **~1.18M** at the November 2024 election to **~1.03M** in this 2026 snapshot — roughly a **13% turnover in eighteen months**, from routine list maintenance (inactive-voter removal, change-of-address, deaths) compounded by the non-persistence of the 121,000 voters who registered same-day on Election Day 2024. That churn is the reason historical turnout *rates* cannot be reconstructed from a single snapshot (Methods) — but it is also a civic-health datapoint in its own right: a roll that turns over this quickly is a moving target for any list-based registration or mobilization effort, and it means "the electorate" is a substantially different set of people each cycle. Washington's file, by comparison, is markedly more stable.

IV. The closed primary *is* the election — and its electorate is grayest of all

In a state where both congressional districts and all 35 legislative districts lean Republican (Section V), the November general ratifies a choice the May Republican primary has already made. Three facts make that literal.

The primary electorate is far more Republican than November. Party composition of each contest, as R-minus-D margin:

Contest	REP	DEM	UNAFF	R − D
Nov 2024 general	64.5%	11.6%	22.6%	+52.9
Nov 2022 general	68.6%	12.1%	18.2%	+56.5
May 2024 primary	**85.2%**	8.3%	5.9%	**+76.8**
May 2022 primary	**85.9%**	8.2%	5.3%	**+77.7**
— Registration baseline	62.9%	11.8%	23.9%	+51.1

The unaffiliated share of the electorate falls from ~24% of the roll to roughly **5–7%** of the primary; the R−D skew widens from ~+51 in November to ~+77 in the primary. **80–86% of every primary ballot cast in Idaho is a Republican ballot** — the range spans every primary cycle in the file, from 79.6% in 2026 to 86.5% in 2022.

The R−D column is computed on **unrounded** shares, so it need not equal the difference of the two printed columns. The May 2024 row is the one where that shows: 85.17 − 8.34 = 76.82, against 85.2 − 8.3 = 76.9 read off the table. The unrounded figure is the one printed.

But "the primary decides" only where the primary is *contested* — and often it isn't. Of the 105 legislative seats, **99 drew a Republican primary in 2024** (the other six are safe-Democratic seats where no Republican filed); of those 99, just **52 (53%) were contested** and **47 (47%) had a single Republican on the ballot** (`scripts/diag_id_primary_contested.py` , reconciled seat-by-seat against the 35-district / 105-seat frame — every race maps 1:1 to a seat, no duplicates; the contested counts match Ballotpedia's independent tallies cycle-by-cycle, exact for 2022 and 2024 and within ±2 for 2016 and 2018). For roughly half of Republican-held legislative seats, then, even the primary offered no choice — the seat was effectively settled at candidate *filing*, an earlier and narrower gate than the primary electorate itself. So the "decisive contest" is, for half the map, no contest at all; for the other half it is the closed, gray, one-party electorate described here.

That contest is, however, growing. Across the loaded cycles the Republican legislative-primary contested rate has roughly *doubled* — **36% (2016) → 43% (2018) → 68% (2022) → 53% (2024)** — peaking in 2022, the first post-redistricting cycle and the height of the state GOP's traditional-vs-hardline fights. (2020 is not comparable: the SoS published that mail-only cycle's legislative results at county level only.) Two things are therefore true at once, and both matter: the decisive Republican primary is *increasingly* a real choice for those who can vote in it, even as it stays *closed* to the ~24% of registrants who are unaffiliated. Democratic legislative primaries, by contrast, are almost never contested (2–14% across these cycles) — the mirror image of one-party dominance.

The primary electorate is older than even the Republican rolls. Comparing all Republican registrants to those who actually pulled a Republican ballot in 2024:

Group	18–29	30–44	45–64	65+	median
Republican registrants (all roll)	12.6%	20.4%	32.5%	34.5%	55
Republican-ballot primary voters, 2024	**5.0%**	14.2%	34.1%	**46.7%**	**63**

The people who nominate Idaho's officeholders are a gray subset of an already-red party: **median age 63, nearly half of them 65+.**

When the unaffiliated do vote in the primary, they pull the Democratic ballot — and even that door is closing. Ballot choice among unaffiliated primary voters:

Primary	→ REP	→ DEM	→ nonpartisan
May 2022	27.7%	52.6%	19.0%
May 2024	9.7%	52.5%	37.5%
May 2026	**1.7%**	**65.6%**	32.6%

Because the Republican primary is closed and the Democratic primary is open to unaffiliated voters, the independents who do participate increasingly do so on the Democratic side — the Republican-ballot share of unaffiliated voters fell from 28% in 2022 to under 2% by 2026, tightening the one-party lock on the decisive contest.

V. Safe-seat Idaho — there is no competitive district by registration

Districts by registration lean (Republican % − Democratic % of registrants):

Level (n)	Safe R (R+40+)	Likely R (R+20–40)	Lean R (R+5–20)	Competitive	Any D lean
Congressional (2)	**2**	0	0	0	0
Legislative (35)	**27**	4	4	**0**	**0**

Both U.S. House seats and every one of the 35 legislative districts lean Republican; **none is competitive by registration, and none leans Democratic.** This is the starkest safe-seat map of the three states studied. Where the general election cannot change an outcome, the closed primary of Section IV is not merely *a* decisive contest — it is the *only* one.

VI. A leading indicator: new registrants are younger and less Republican

Party mix and age of each registration cohort still on the current roll:

First registered	new regs	% REP	% DEM	% UNAFF	median age at reg
2008	22,559	66.4%	5.3%	28.0%	45
2012	30,843	71.5%	11.8%	15.9%	47
2016	61,465	65.5%	12.1%	21.2%	46
2020	153,710	60.8%	12.2%	25.1%	43
2022	97,593	64.8%	11.3%	21.8%	44
2024	263,322	**57.5%**	12.4%	**28.3%**	**35**

Idaho's newest voters are markedly younger (median age at registration 35 vs 45–47 a decade earlier) and less Republican (57.5% vs the high-60s/low-70s of earlier cohorts). But the dilution flows to **unaffiliated, not Democratic** — the Democratic share is flat near 12% across two decades while the unaffiliated share climbs to 28%. The rolls are slowly loosening the two-party grip, but toward the bloc that Section III showed is structurally shut out of the primary. Absent a change in primary rules, a growing, younger, unaffiliated electorate has *less* say in who governs, not more.

VII. The donor class is not the electorate — and leans against the rolls

Matching the roll to Idaho Sunshine state-campaign contributions links **23,613 registered voters to 114,806 donations ($13.64M)**. The match uses the full-name key alone (last name + full first name + ZIP5), the specification adopted across this series on 2026-07-27 after a stratified blinded validation measured it at 100% precision (120/120) while initial-based keys ran 48–72%; see the donor-class companion, Appendix F. The restriction buys that precision at a cost worth stating where the findings are read rather than in a methods note: it **discards 11–19% of matched donors, who are younger and less Democratic than those retained**, so some part of the age and party skews below is selection rather than measurement. The superseded all-tier figures are the more conservative ones and are reported in the companion. Characterized by the donor's own party of record:

Party	donors	donor share	reg share	skew	$ share
Republican	15,645	66.3%	62.9%	+3.4	72.2%
Democratic	5,097	21.6%	11.8%	**+9.8**	20.0%
Unaffiliated	2,735	11.6%	23.9%	**−12.3**	7.6%
Other	136	0.6%	1.4%	−0.9	0.2%

Even in a state this red, the donor class **over-represents registered Democrats** — they are 12% of the roll but 21% of donors and give 21% of the money, nearly double their registration weight — while the unaffiliated quarter is again nearly absent (12% of donors, 8% of dollars). Republicans still supply the plurality of money in absolute terms, as a 63%-Republican state must, but relative to their numbers the *most* over-represented donors are Democrats.

The donor class is also **grayer and more concentrated** than the electorate:

- **Age.** 51% of matched donors are 65+, versus 31% of the roll and 33% of 2024 general voters; the under-30 share is 2.1% versus 15% of the roll. (All three are computed on current-roll age, so they share one basis; the age-at-election figures in Section I are not interchangeable with them.) The donor class is the oldest layer of all.
- **Concentration.** The top 1% of matched donors supply **40%** of the matched dollars; the top 10% supply **71%**.
- **Geography.** Ada County (Boise) alone accounts for **50%** of matched donor dollars — the money mirror of the population-vs-influence gap seen in New York (Manhattan) and Washington (Seattle).

- **Where the money sits.** Donor party mix tracks district safety. Grouping the 35 districts by the same registration lean used in Section V, the 27 Solid-R districts hold 14,594 donors who are **78% Republican / 13% Democratic**, while the eight Likely-R and Lean-R districts hold 9,019 donors at a far more balanced **47% / 35%**. Idaho's competitive-adjacent seats are where the two parties' donor bases actually meet.

Crossover — where the money goes. Idaho Sunshine carries no party on the recipient record, but recipient party can be reconstructed from data on hand (the Secretary of State candidate roster plus party/committee name patterns), which resolves the recipient for **51% of matched donors and 41% of matched dollars** (`scripts/backfill_id_recipient_party.py`). Among donors whose money reached a party-resolvable recipient:

Donor's registration	→ gave only to D	→ gave only to R	mixed
Republican	19.1%	79.0%	1.9%
Democratic	**94.6%**	3.0%	2.3%
Unaffiliated	**77.1%**	20.5%	2.3%

Registered Democrats are near-monolithic donors (95% give only to Democrats — the same loyalty seen in New York), and unaffiliated donors lean nearly **4:1 Democratic** when their money can be traced, echoing the blank-bloc donor lean in New York. Republicans predominantly fund Republicans (79%); the apparent ~19% giving only to Democrats is an **upper bound** — the unresolved recipient pool (local Republican candidates and R-aligned PACs not in the roster) skews Republican, so Republican donors' Republican-side giving is disproportionately the part left untraced. The robust, direction-safe reads are the Democratic loyalty and the unaffiliated Democratic tilt.

Boundary of inference

- **Age is imputed from a single integer.** Idaho gives current age, not DOB, so election-time ages are ±1 year and we report only bands and medians, never exact ages. This cannot manufacture the effects shown — the primary/general and cohort gaps are far larger than a one-year imputation error.
- **Survivorship — why this paper reports no turnout rates.** The 2026 roll (1.03M) is smaller than the ~1.18M registered at the 2024 election, because Idaho purges inactive registrations and same-day registrants churn. Dividing past voters by this shrunken roll inflates every turnout rate: our all-voter 2024 general rate is ~94% against the official **77.8%** (917,608 ballots / 1,178,750 registered, Idaho SoS), and 2020 even computes above 100% — voters who re-registered after 2020 carry a later `registration_date`, dropping out of the denominator while staying in the numerator. The bias is not uniform (larger for the young, unaffiliated, and movers), so cross-group rate comparisons are unreliable too. We therefore report **composition shares** — each group's share of the actual electorate — throughout, which need no registration denominator.
- **The survivorship bias runs *against* the gray finding.** Comparing Washington's 2023 and 2026 roll snapshots, the voters who leave the rolls skew *older* (33% are 65+ vs 24% of those retained — deaths dominate). Reconstructing a past electorate from the current roll therefore *under-counts* its oldest members: the true past electorates were, if anything, grayer than measured here, so the age findings are a lower bound. (Idaho has no prior snapshot to measure directly, but attrition dominated by mortality is a general mechanism.)
- **This is a claim about composition and closure, not ideological extremism.** Sides, Tausanovitch, Vavreck & Warshaw (2020) find primary electorates are not dramatically more extreme than their party's rank-and-file, and that openness rules do not change that — a result that rebuts a *polarization* argument. It does not bear on the argument here, which is about *who is in the room* (one party, older, the unaffiliated excluded) and who is shut out, not about the ideology of those who show up. We make no claim that Idaho's primary voters are more extreme than other Republicans.
- **The donor layer here is state (Idaho Sunshine) by design.** It characterizes the people who fund Idaho's *state* campaigns — the relevant layer for state electoral health. (Idaho's **federal** FEC contributions were since loaded too — 770,765 rows / $76.2M outflow + inflow, with 23,303 FEC voter↔donor matches on the full-name key. The cross-state comparison in `cross-state-fec-money.md` §F5 uses the **pooled** Idaho match instead — both money systems in one table, 41,136 donors — and its mix D 20% / R 67% / O 13% closely tracks the Sunshine-only mix below. The age skew survives the matcher-bias re-weighting in ID as in WA/NY.) Recipient party is not in the feed; it is reconstructed for ~51% of matched donors (candidate roster + committee-name patterns), so the crossover table above is limited to party-resolvable recipients and the majority-party crossover rate is an upper bound (see §VII).

- **Lean is never imputed for the unaffiliated.** Every "unaffiliated" figure is a registration fact, not an inferred partisanship.

What it means

Idaho is the limiting case of the on-cycle-timing argument. Washington showed the off-year electorate is older; New York showed the shrinkage is party-shaped and excludes a young unaffiliated bloc; Idaho shows what happens when a single closed primary, not November, is the entire game. The decision is made by a Republican electorate grayer than the Republican rolls, in districts where the general cannot overturn it and — for about half of seats — where even the primary is uncontested, while a growing quarter of the state stands outside the only contest that counts.

The obvious remedies are institutional: open the primary, or move the decisive contest onto the high-turnout November calendar. But Idaho has just weighed and rejected the first. **Proposition 1 (2024)** — which would have replaced the closed primary with a single top-four open primary and added ranked-choice voting in November — **lost 69.6% to 30.4%.** That result does not refute this paper; it illustrates its mechanism. A reform that would enlarge and de-close the electorate is itself decided *by the existing electorate*, through the very turnout-and-general structure the reform targets — and the people currently outside the room do not, from outside it, have the numbers to open the door. The finding here is therefore less a policy recommendation than the description of a **self-reinforcing equilibrium**: a closed, gray, one-party primary (contested in only about half of seats) selects the officials, and the broader electorate that might change the rules is precisely the one the rules leave least able to.

Related work

This paper documents, with unusually rich individual-level data, mechanisms that are largely established; its contribution is the measurement and the party-neutral age result, not the discovery of the mechanisms. It sits in these literatures:

- **The one-party primary as the real election.** V.O. Key, *Southern Politics in State and Nation* (1949) — in a one-party polity the dominant party's primary is the decisive contest; the general ratifies it. This paper is a modern, individual-level instance.
- **Surge-and-decline / turnout composition by salience.** Campbell, "Surge and Decline" (1960); Wolfinger & Rosenstone, *Who Votes?* (1980); Leighley & Nagler, *Who Votes Now?* (2013). Section I's presidential→midterm falloff is this.
- **Off-cycle / election-timing and representation.** Anzia, *Timing and Turnout* (2014); Hajnal & Trounstine (2005); Kogan, Lavertu & Peskowitz (2018, on school boards); Einstein et al., "The Gray Vote" (2024) — the closest analog to the age result. Motivates the on-cycle remedy.
- **Primary-electorate representativeness (the tension).** Sides, Tausanovitch, Vavreck & Warshaw, "On the Representativeness of Primary Electorates" (2020) — primaries are not dramatically more *extreme*; distinguished here (our claim is composition/closure, not extremism).
- **Independents / the unaffiliated.** Klar & Krupnikov, *Independent Politics* (2016).
- **Voter-file / individual-level method.** Ansolabehere & Hersh, "Validation..." (2012); Hersh, *Hacking the Electorate* (2015). On the roll-churn caveat: Feder & Miller, "The Racial Burden of Voter List Maintenance Errors," *Science Advances* (2020).
- **The donor class.** Bonica, DIME / "Mapping the Ideological Marketplace" (2014); Schlozman, Verba & Brady, *The Unheavenly Chorus* (2012); Hill & Huber, "...the Contemporary Donorate" (2017, on donors' older skew); Grumbach, Sahn & Staszak (2022).
- **The reform just rejected.** Idaho Proposition 1 (2024), top-four open primary + ranked-choice voting, defeated 69.6%–30.4% (Idaho SoS).

Methods & reproducibility

```
# 1. Load the Idaho voter file -> data/id_vrdb.duckdb (voters + voter_participation)
python scripts/load_id_voters.py

# 2. Turnout by age x party + the closed-primary flagship (Sections I-IV)
python scripts/diag_id_turnout_party.py

# 2b. Contested vs uncontested primaries (Section IV) - SoS 2024 primary canvass
python scripts/diag_id_primary_contested.py

# 3. Donor class x party (Section VII) - resolve recipient party (crossover),
#    then match; writes committee_party_override + voter_donor_affiliation_state.
#    --source state is the Sunshine layer this section reports; --source fec builds
#    the federal panel used by the cross-state comparison. Both default to the
#    full-name key (the primary specification).
STATE=ID python scripts/backfill_id_recipient_party.py
STATE=ID python scripts/match_id_voters_to_donors.py --source state

# 4. Electorate extras: unaffiliated bloc, decomposition, cohort trend,
#    safe-seat map, donor-mix x competitiveness (Sections I, III, V, VI, VII)
python scripts/diag_id_electorate_extras.py
```

Source: `data/raw/id/id_statewide_voter_history_20260629.csv` (Idaho SoS statewide voter file with history, 2026-06-29 export; public record). Party buckets: REP / DEM / UNAFF (unaffiliated) / OTHER (Libertarian + Constitution). All headline numbers above are re-derivable by running the scripts in this block.